Business Intelligence Systems

INFO 4555 5556

Fall 2025

Dimensional Data Modeling Concepts Review



Cornell University

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1) What type of Fact table would be best for measuring facts about what has occurred?

A: Transactional Fact

B: Periodic Snapshot Fact

C: Accumulating Snapshot Fact

D: Factless Fact

E: None of the above

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2) What term is used in Dimensional Modeling for handling changing dimensional attribute values?

A: Standard Context Dating

B: History Track Dimensions

C: Slowly Changing Dimensions

D: Context Historical Reference Mapping

E: None of the above

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3) Goals of Dimensional Data Modeling include:

A: Ease of querying by Business users

B: Good analytic query performance

C: Merging of disparate data

D: Historical context

E: All of the above

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4) What is the problem with including percentages and ratios in a fact table?

a. Percentages and ratios are not measures

b. It is faster to calculate these values “on the fly”

c. Percentages and ratios are non-additive

d. Percentages and ratios should be stored in dimension tables

e. None of the above

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5) An example of a semi-additive fact would be:

a. A prime number

b. Purchase price in a transactional fact table

c. Account balance in a periodic snapshot fact table

d. A Lag fact in an accumulative snapshot fact table

e. None of the above

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6) Primary keys are maintained within the data warehouse as surrogate keys because:

a. They are fully additive

b. It is the only way to guarantee uniqueness over time

c. Data Modelers like to add additional work for the ETL developers

d. They are smart keys

e. All of the above

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7) What type of Fact table is designed to track pipeline performance?

a. Transactional Fact

b. Periodic Snapshot Fact

c. Accumulating Snapshot Fact

d. Factless Fact

e. None of the above

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8) All of the following are traits of Dimensional tables, except:

a. Many columns versus number of records

b. Fewer columns versus number of records

c. Give context to the facts (measures)

d. Answer the Who, What, When, Where of the facts in data model

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9) A degenerate dimension:

a. Is never recommended in Dimensional Modeling

b. Is a dimension containing "problem records"

c. Is a dimension with no content except its primary key

d. Is generally the largest dimension in a dimensional model

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10) Which Slowly Changing Dimension Type is the most commonly used for tracking attribute history?

a. Type 0

b. Type 1

c. Type 2

d. Type 3

e. Type 4

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11) Which Slowly Changing Dimension Type only retains the current value for an attribute?

a. Type 0

b. Type 1

c. Type 2

d. Type 3

e. Type 4

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12) In Business Intelligence and Data Warehousing the acronym ETL stands for:

a. Enterprise Transaction Loading

b. Extract Transform Load

c. Every Transaction Loaded

d. Error Transformation Lead

e. None of the above

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